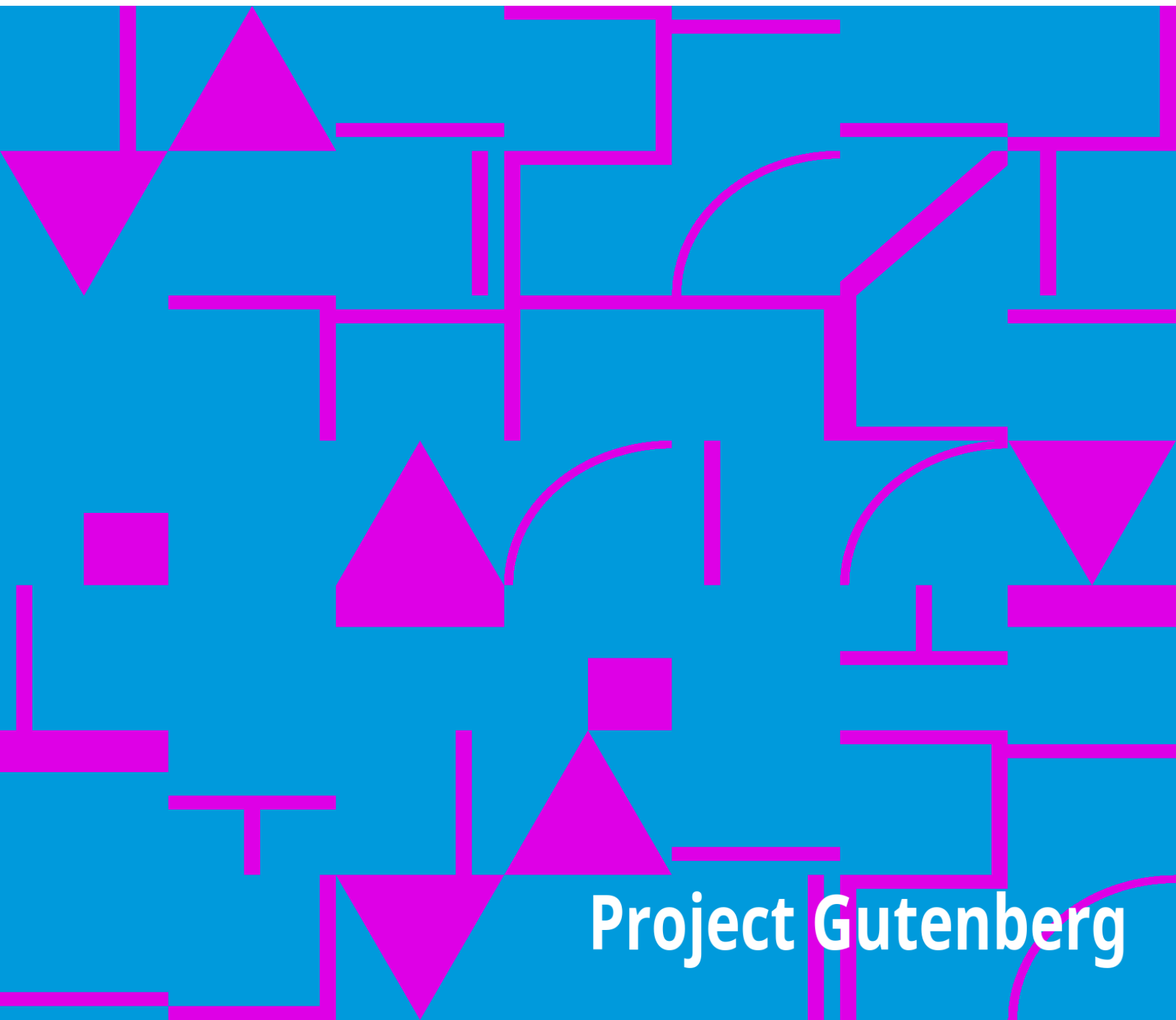


Harper's Young People, August 8, 1882

Various

The background of the lower half of the image is a solid blue field. Overlaid on this field is a complex, abstract pattern of magenta-colored geometric shapes. These shapes include various sizes of triangles (some pointing up, some pointing down), squares, rectangles, and L-shaped or stepped lines. Some of the shapes are solid, while others appear to be outlines or have a slightly different texture. The overall effect is a modern, graphic design that contrasts with the historical text above.

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Harper's Young People, August 8, 1882

Various

An abstract geometric pattern consisting of various shapes like triangles, squares, and lines in magenta and blue colors, creating a complex, layered design.

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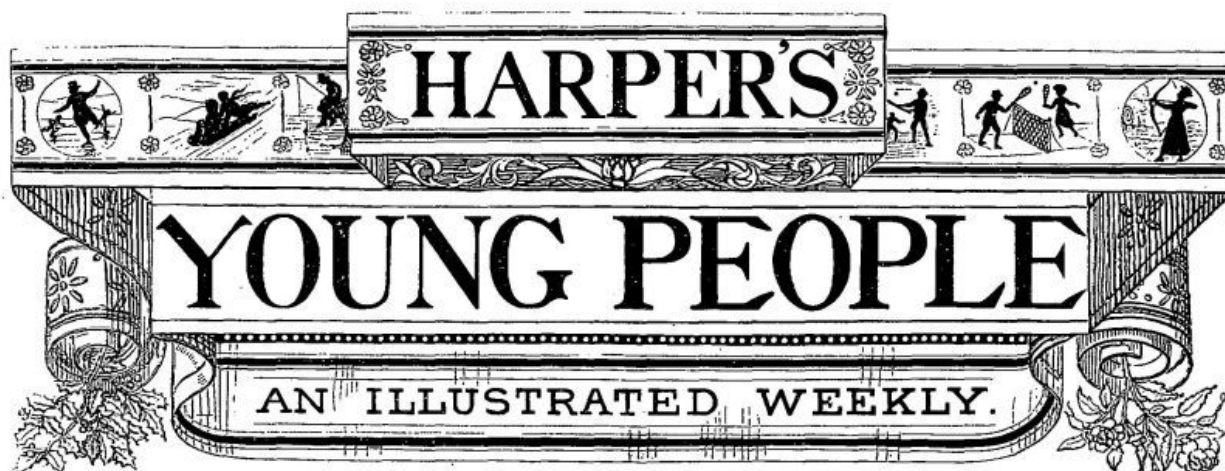
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VOL. III.—NO. 145.

Tuesday, August 8,
1882.

PUBLISHED BY HARPER & BROTHERS, NEW
YORK.

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PRICE FOUR CENTS.

\$1.50 per Year, in
Advance.



**TOBY RESCUES THE CROWING HEN FROM MR.
STUBBS'S BROTHER.**

MR. STUBBS'S BROTHER. ^[1]

BY JAMES OTIS,

AUTHOR OF "TOBY TYLER," "TIM AND TIP," ETC.

CHAPTER XIX.

THE BREAKING UP OF THE SHOW.

Now that the boys had found cages ready-made, and needing only some bars or slats across the front, they did not think it necessary to hurry. They staid for some time to talk of Abner, and to test some doughnuts Aunt Olive was frying. It is very likely that they would have remained even longer if the doughnut-frying had not been completed, and the tempting dainties placed upon a high shelf beyond their reach, as a gentle intimation that they had had about as many as they would get that afternoon.

After leaving the house they walked leisurely toward the barn, little dreaming what a state of confusion their property was in, until Reddy rushed out of the tent, his jacket torn, his face bleeding, and his general appearance that of a boy who had been having rather a hard time of it.

"Why, what's the matter? Why don't you stay an' watch the animals?" asked Bob, in a tone intended to convey reproach and surprise that one of the projectors of the enterprise should desert his post.

"Watch the animals?" screamed Reddy, in a rage. "You go an' watch 'em awhile instead of eatin' doughnuts, an' see how you like it. Mr. Stubbs's brother picked a hole in the bag so my cat got out, an' she jumped on the calf, an' he tore 'round awful till he let the hen an' Mrs. Simpson's cat loose, an' I got knocked down an' scratched, an' the whole show's broke up."

Reddy sat down on the ground, and wiped the blood from his face after he had imparted the painful news; and all the party started for the tent as rapidly as possible.

It was a scene of utter ruin which they looked in upon after they had pulled aside Mr. Mansfield's flag, and one which was well calculated to discourage amateur circus proprietors.

Mr. Stubbs's brother was seated amid Reddy's paper and paint, holding the crowing hen by the head while he picked her wing feathers out one by one. Mrs. Simpson's cat and kittens each had one of Bob's mice in its mouth, while Reddy's cat was chasing one of the squirrels with a murderous purpose. The calf was no longer an inmate of the tent; but a large rent in the canvas showed that he had opened a door for himself when the cat scratched him; and afar in the distance he could be seen, head down and tail up, as if fleeing from everything that looked like a circus.

The destruction was as complete as it could well have been made in so short a time, and the partners were, quite naturally, discouraged. Toby retained sufficient presence of mind, amid the trouble, to rescue the crowing hen from the murderous clutches of Mr. Stubbs's brother, and the monkey scampered up the tent-pole, brandishing two or three of the poor creature's best and longest wing feathers, while he screamed with satisfaction that he had accomplished at least a portion of the work of stripping the fowl.

"The show's broke up, an' that's all there's to it," said Bob, sorrowfully, as he gazed alternately at the hole in the canvas and his rapidly vanishing calf.

"Are the squirrels all gone?" asked Joe, driving the cat from her intended prey long enough to allow Master Bushy-tail to gain a refuge under the barn.

"Every one," replied Reddy. "The calf kicked the box over when he come toward me, an' it looked as if there was as many as a hundred come out jest as soon as the cover was off. I could have caught one or two; but somehow Mrs. Simpson's cat got out of the basket jest then,' an' she flew right into my face."

The marks on Reddy's cheeks and nose told most eloquently with what force the cat "flew," and search was at once made for that pet of the Simpson family. She, with her kittens, had taken refuge under the barn as soon as the boys entered, and thus another trouble was added to the load the circus managers had to bear, for that cat must be returned to her mistress by night, or trouble might come of it.

The mice were entirely consumed, two tails alone remaining of what would have been shown to the good people of Guilford as strange animals from some far-off country.

The squirrels were gone, the calf had fled, the hen was in a thoroughly battered condition, and nothing remained of all that vast and wonderful collection of animals except Mr. Stubbs's brother, and the rabbits, protected by the cage which their master's thoughtfulness had provided.

"I guess I'll take the rabbits home," said Leander, as he lifted the box to his shoulder. "It wouldn't do to have only them for animals, an' it ain't very certain how long they'll stay alive while that monkey's 'round."

"He's broke up the whole show, that's what he's done," and Ben shook his fist at Mr. Stubbs's brother, while he tried to soothe his half-plucked hen.

"What *are* we goin' to do?" asked Toby, almost in despair.

"I know what I'm goin' to do," said Ben, as he again placed the hen under the basket; "I'm goin' to crawl under the barn an' try to catch that cat, an' then I'm goin' home with my hen."

It seemed to be the desire of all the partners to get home with what remained of their pets, and as Ben went under the barn on his hands and knees, Leander started off with his rabbits, Bob went to look for his calf, Reddy gathered up his bundle of paper, and Joe seized his pasteboard box, all going away where they could think over the ruin in solitude.

But high up on the post the cause of all this trouble chattered and scolded, while his master sat on the ground, looking at him as if he wondered whether or not it would ever be possible to reform such a monkey.

[TO BE CONTINUED.]

A TIGRESS HUNT.

On a dark evening in December the little village of Sundapoor, Northern India, presented a picturesque appearance. Each bamboo hut whose inmate could afford it had hung out a red or yellow paper lantern; fire-works exploded gayly amongst the banyans and tamarind-trees; the whole population of the place was gathered around three large bonfires at the east end of the single street. This demonstration was all in honor of the arrival an hour before, of Sir Dyce Hanchett—of whom so many boys and girls have read—the famous young English sportsman from Madras. Sir Dyce Hanchett had come full twenty miles out of his route expressly to attempt ridding Sundapoor and its neighborhood of its dreaded curse for so many long months, the detested man-eater Kali.

No single tiger had ever wrought such destruction within a little district. The herds had been thinned beast by beast. In August the old Buddhist priest Padará had been seized in the moon-lit street before his door, and borne away, crying out feebly, into the jungle before help was at hand; two women, one at the well in the afternoon, and the other a few days later while returning from her milking at twilight, were no more heard of until their bones were found whitening in a dry ravine. But the dry ravine was not the home of Kali—for so they called her, after the Hindoo goddess of murder—nor could they find it. The timid villagers' hunting parties had been to no purpose. Their second one indeed was overtaken by night, and before Sundapoor was reached a roar was heard in the midst of the group; a terrible creature leaped across their smouldering camp fire, and disappeared with one of their number. In the morning, a mile away, the half-devoured body of the man was found and buried. Kali had not carried it to her lair. No wonder that the unhappy people of Sundapoor began to believe that the tigress was some evil spirit in quadruped form that no eye should trace nor bullet kill.

Sir Dyce, however, only laughed at the superstition of the group, as he sat, surrounded with his men, in the largest bungalow of the little place, organizing his party for the morning. Even Ram Bane, the greatest coward of all, exclaimed: "I have comfort when I behold this stately Englishman, his guns, his bullets. And hearken to his elephant eating behind the bungalow!"

At dawn he and his party were off. Out through the village street with horns and tam-tams the procession moved. The preceding afternoon a bullock had been seized. The crushed twigs and jungle grass, often spotted with gore, were now traced for a mile by the trackers. Suddenly a shout went up from these. "The bullock! the bullock!" Sure enough, when Sir Dyce had forced his way with two others into the open, there on the jungle's edge lay what was left of the unlucky animal. "Hurrah!" cried the enthusiastic Englishman; "she can not be far away. Get together, all of you, quickly. Beat the bush on the other side of us—yonder, across the clearing."

Sir Dyce left his elephant, and joined on foot the excited natives. The open was crossed. Wild cries and shouts, the clanging of the cymbals and tam-tams, filled the morning air. The bush was thoroughly beat, every eye and ear on the alert.

Sir Dyce and his party located themselves carefully in the underbrush within easy shot of the carcass. It was their best chance. The afternoon passed slowly. Each member of the little ambushade had become a sentinel. But no tigress came slinking into sight. The shadows grew purple. Sir Dyce began to doubt the wisdom of further remaining in so exposed a spot without a regular camping out. Or had not they best return to Sundapoor? The elephant had been stationed some hundred yards to the rear. Suddenly an old native laid his hand warningly upon Sir Dyce's

sleeve. The English hunter started, and looked out from behind their screen toward the little clearing. Full in face of them, every line and curve of her beautiful form brought into relief by the distance and the green shade behind her, was seated at last a tigress on the opposite side of the open. The great beast was indeed returning from her lair, either to finish her supper here and now, or else to forage for another one.

She sat there upon her haunches very composedly, looking over at the bullock. Perhaps she suspected something. At all events, she seemed reluctant to stir just yet. She remained well out of range, licking her paws, and preening herself precisely like pussy before the fire.

The natives with Sir Dyce in his lurking-place would have risked a shot already had he not checked them. After a moment, however, the great cat raised her head, then lowered it, smelling the ground, and finally advanced slowly toward the dead bullock. The excitement of the natives upon actually beholding before them the dreaded marauder and murderess of their district was evinced by their breathless watchfulness of every motion she made.

The tigress gained the side of the bullock. Thereupon she stooped, and, much to Sir Dyce's discomfiture, instead of beginning her supper then and there, began easily and rapidly to drag the bullock back toward the opposite thicket.

There was no time in such an event to be wasted. The elephant was not available. Sir Dyce stepped quickly from cover and fired. Two of his native companions followed his example. The tigress started, uninjured, dropped the carcass, and turned. Perceiving the hunters, she stood for an instant in a dignified attitude, then roared, lashed her tail furiously, and charged down upon them. The natives shrieked, and rushed pell-mell back. Sir Dyce fired, and pierced the brute's shoulder. She now charged furiously upon him as he stood alone just forward of the edge of the jungle. His last bullet met her. She leaped into the air, rolled over and over in her death-agony, and then lay rigid and motionless. No more cattle or priests or women would Kali bear away from Sundapoor or any other village.

The natives approached the dead beast tremblingly, and offered prayers to the great goddess whose name they had given it, before they ventured to take the creature home in triumph. Sir Dyce had a rude ovation in Sundapoor that evening that he often smiled over afterward. He cared less for the songs sung in his honor, less for the fire-works and drumming and the procession around his camp-stool, than he did for the noble skin that afterward he took to his English home for his little sons to roll upon. But then only an Indian village that has been long in terror from a man-eater can appreciate what a relief he and a good English gun had given it.

HISTORICAL TREES OF MEXICO.

BY HELEN S. CONANT.

Certain species of trees live to a very great age. There are trees in existence which are supposed to be more than a thousand years old, and many of them are intimately connected with historical events of the past. In Morat, a town in Switzerland, where in 1476 a great victory was won by the Swiss over Charles the Bold, is a famous lime-tree under which Charles and his Generals sat down to rest before the battle; and in another Swiss village a lime-tree is still standing, flourishing and green in its old age, upon whose trunk in 1530 was pasted the proclamation of the Reformation.

Many of our youthful readers will remember the account of some historical trees of the United States given in the second volume of *YOUNG PEOPLE*, and the interest it awakened for collecting and exchanging leaves and twigs from these noble old landmarks, and we think they will be interested to hear about two magnificent cypress-trees near the city of Mexico. The oldest trees in the world are supposed to exist in the cypress forests of Mexico. These cypresses grow to an immense height, and the trunk which supports the great crown of feathery foliage is sometimes more than one hundred feet in circumference.

When in 1519 Cortez landed on the Mexican coast, at the point where the city of Vera Cruz is now situated, he found the country populated with Indians, who received him in the most friendly manner, and very soon he was visited by two messengers, who came from a certain great King called Montezuma. They brought him rich presents, but entreated him to leave the country. Now Cortez was a man of very determined character. He had come to Mexico to make new conquests for the Emperor Charles V.; so he paid no heed to Montezuma's message, but prepared himself and his Spanish soldiery to march inland, and see the great magnificence which he was told existed at the court of this powerful King. Fearing that a portion if not all of his army might desert him, he burned his ships, and thus cut off all means of retreat.

After a long and weary march, Cortez and his men arrived at the city of Mexico, where the beautiful sight that appeared before their astonished eyes made them feel as if they had reached the gates of an enchanted realm. This capital of the great Aztec nation was built in the centre of a large lake, and was connected with the surrounding country by broad causeways. The surface of the lake was dotted with floating gardens, and in the city great towers and temples and palaces of solid masonry rose above the trees. Many of the streets were broad and well paved, others were waterways like those of Venice, and crowded with canoes that went back and forth loaded with fruit, flowers, and all kinds of merchandise.

But in the midst of this fair city was a terrible spot, where dreadful deeds were done, for which the people well deserved the punishment which soon fell upon them. It was the great Temple of the Sun, and upon its summit stood a huge hideous idol of stone, which the people worshipped, and before which they sacrificed many thousands of poor men, women, and children.

Montezuma, the great Aztec King, thought himself a very wise ruler. He had magnificent palaces and pleasure-gardens filled with flowers and noble trees. One of his favorite palaces was situated several miles from the city. It was built on a hill, and from its windows the King could overlook the beautiful valley in the centre of which stood the city, and watch the great volcano of Popocatepetl, which at that time often threw forth smoke and burning lava. At the foot of the hill,



THE FAVORITE TREE OF MONTEZUMA.

all around the palace, was a great park, in which grew many large cypress-trees. One was Montezuma's favorite tree. He had a seat built under it, and was accustomed to meet his warriors there and confer with them. That was more than three hundred and sixty years ago, but the tree still stands, strong and flourishing, and showing no signs of decay. It is thought to be one of the oldest trees in the world. On sunny afternoons little Indian boys and girls play around its enormous trunk in the shade of its broad-spreading foliage, and they will all tell you that it is Montezuma's tree under which they are playing, for it still is remembered in connection with its ancient owner. This wonderful tree has witnessed many strange events. It saw the downfall of Montezuma, and the end of the terrible human sacrifices; it was a silent witness while the Spaniards held rule over New Spain, as Mexico was for a time called; it stood safely

through the great revolution of sixty years ago, when the Mexicans fought for liberty, and throwing off the Spanish yoke, founded a republic of their own. In 1847, the bullets of American soldiers whizzed through its branches, as our army, led by General Scott, stormed under it and up the hill to take the Mexican fortress built on the heights where centuries ago stood the pleasure-palace of Montezuma. During the three years' rule of the French in Mexico, from 1864 to 1867, when the republic was crushed, and Maximilian of Austria was Emperor, this old tree shadowed the pathway where Maximilian and his Empress passed on their way to their beautiful pleasure-palace, which crowned the height above as in the days of Montezuma. This hill was called Chapultepec by the ancient Aztecs, which signifies the hill of grasshoppers, and it bears the same name still.

The other historical cypress-tree stands on a village green about three miles from the city of Mexico. Until nine years ago it was a noble tree, but one night a party of Indians kindled a fire which burned out the entire centre of the immense trunk, and left it only a scorched wreck of its former splendor. Many of its branches are still adorned with feathery foliage, and it is draped with hanging gray moss, similar to that which grows on many trees in the Southern United States, which gives it a venerable and hoary appearance suited to its great age. It is called "*The Tree of the Noche Triste*," meaning the sad night. To understand its name, we must follow the adventures of Cortez and his men after their arrival at the city of Mexico.

Montezuma, although very suspicious of these white-faced strangers who came riding on horses, which were animals unknown to the Aztecs, and bringing with them great cannon which made a noise like thunder, received them kindly, and gave splendid banquets in their honor.

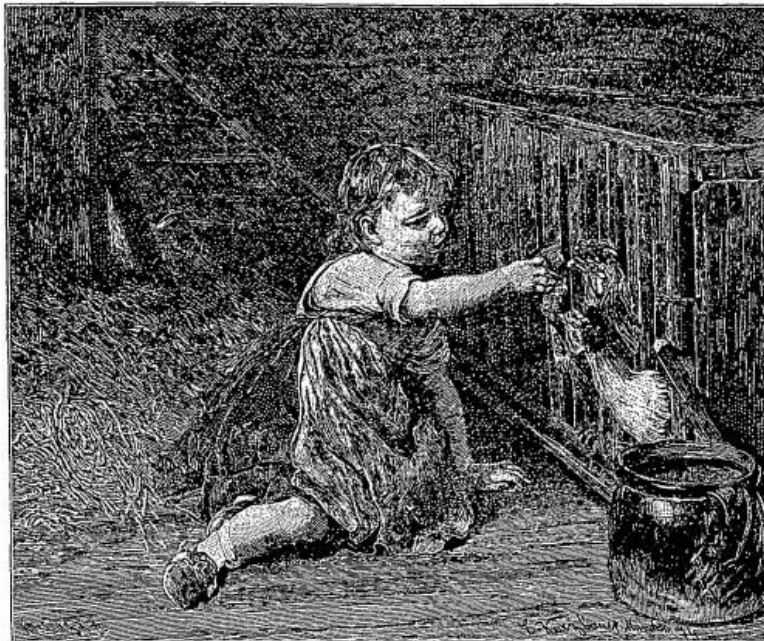
But Cortez had not come to Mexico to live in luxury, but to gain possession of the country, and the horrible human sacrifices which he daily witnessed strengthened his resolution to break down the Aztec power at any cost, and to establish the government and religion of Spain. The task was difficult, for he was alone in a strange land, with only a handful of men at his command. His first attempt ended in disaster. He succeeded in seizing the person of Montezuma, the King, but the Mexicans rebelled against the rule of the Spanish soldiery. In one of the battles Montezuma was

killed, which only increased the fury of the Mexicans against the strangers with white faces. After losing many of his men, Cortez finally decided to retreat from the city. It was a dark rainy night in the summer of 1520 when with the remnant of his army he passed out over one of the great causeways, closely pursued by the furious Mexicans, who fired showers of sharply pointed arrows after him. When at last he found himself in the open country, free from his enemies, who had returned to their strongholds, Cortez sat down under the great cypress-tree to rest. For the first time his heart failed him, and all alone, in the dark stormy night, the stern warrior shed bitter tears. And to this day the tree preserves the memory of that sad hour in the name by which it is known.



"THE TREE OF THE NOCHE TRISTE."

The determination of Cortez to conquer Mexico became stronger than ever after this bitter defeat. He immediately set to work to re-enforce his army by making friends with tribes who had suffered oppression from the powerful Aztecs. Fresh troops also arrived from Spain, and in a year after the sad night, Cortez saw conquered Mexico at his feet, and its great cities in the hands of Spanish soldiers. The temples stained with the blood of so many unfortunate victims were overthrown, and in their places churches were built, with towers bearing the sign of the cross. Idolatry and human sacrifice on Mexican soil were ended forever.



FEEDING HIS PETS.

RUTH'S OPPORTUNITY.

BY BELLE WILLIAMS.



brighter morning never dawned on the little township of Greenville than that of a certain day in the summer of '81. The sun rose with a fierce glare, boding intense heat before night-fall. Every ray seemed like a fiery dart sent down to destroy the few lingering traces of verdure, for rain had not fallen in weeks, and plants and animals were alike consumed with thirst.

The sun had wide range for havoc on Mr. Leonard's farm, and it blazed relentlessly down upon his well-tilled acres, upon his roomy barns and stables, which sheltered the panting cattle, and upon a little "root-house," used as a storage for winter vegetables, that stood half underground and covered with earth. But on this retreat the tyrant cast his beams in vain. The shadowy room within was delightfully cool, and there in the doorway lay little Scott, the

five-year-old baby of the household, with his chin resting on two chubby palms, his elbows planted in the damp earth, and heels beating the air, intently watching a swarm of ants. The old root-house had been a favorite haunt of the little fellow during the hot, sultry days of summer, for it was so near the kitchen that he never felt lonely there.

"Breakfast 'most ready, Ruthie?" he called out, still surveying the interesting ant colony.

"Almost, little man," said sister Ruth, appearing at the porch door to see what the small lord was about.

Ruth Leonard made a charming picture as she stood there shading her eyes with her hand, framed in by a clustering mass of honeysuckle vines. Yet no one called her a pretty girl. Though only sixteen, she was very tall and strong for her age; every well-formed limb indicated the possession of muscular strength, and her broad shoulders seemed just fitted to bear burdens. Her thick brown hair was brushed plainly back from a low forehead and braided, but the braid was oftener coiled up in a loose knot to "get it out of the way." Not a suspicion of a curl was to be seen, for Ruth always forgot to "put up her hair," and Nature had evidently intended it to hang straight. A pair of keen gray eyes that often grew dark with unsatisfied longing, yet hid in their depths a world of conscious power, a straight nose, and full red lips, complete the picture—a picture which had become to father and mother as their daily bread.

Ruth turned away smiling, and went on with her work of setting the table. Suddenly a shrill voice echoed through the room. "Hi, Betty! ho, Betty! it's all in m'eye!" came with piercing distinctness from the open doorway, accompanied by scuffling as of a brigade of robbers, and boisterous Hal presented himself.

"Now, Hal—" began Ruth.

"Now, grandmother," reiterated Hal, striking an attitude, "don't reel off more than a yard of lecture before breakfast."

"Henry, behave," commanded a stern voice from the other side of the room, which caused a noticeable decline in Hal's spirits.

There stood Mr. Leonard, having just come down-stairs unnoticed by the young scapegrace. He held little Lou by the hand, a delicate, sensitive child, older than Hal, though scarcely taller than her sturdy brother.

"Here come the provisions," remarked Hal, as Ruth brought in a smoking omelet from the kitchen.

"Go call Scott," said his father; which, cruel mandate obliged the young gentleman to remove his admiring gaze from the repast.

"Ay, ay, sir," he responded, and in a few minutes he reappeared with Scott, who was very red in the face, and howling most frantically. Hal had the little fellow's skirts gathered tightly in one hand, while with the other he firmly grasped the neck of his dress, just as he had picked him up from the ground, "making him walk Spanish," as he termed it.

The family gathered around the table, and Mr. Leonard asked a blessing on the food in a sad, pleading voice. For several minutes the children seemed awed into silence. At length Ruth broke the stillness.

"Did you see the doctor again last night, father?"

"Yes, daughter."

"What did he say?" she eagerly asked.

Mr. Leonard could not at once trust himself to speak, but after a moment he replied, in a husky voice, "The doctor says your mother will never walk again."

The quick tears sprang to the girl's eyes as she thought of the dear little Quaker mother upstairs, lying so patiently on her bed of suffering, who only a year ago, before that terrible fall which hurt her back, had been well and happy.

Lou began to sob outright, and great-hearted Hal again brushed his coat sleeve over his face, but this time to wipe away the tears.

"Does mother know it?" asked Ruth.

"Yes."

"How does she feel about it?"

"Cheerful as ever," replied Mr. Leonard. "She never thinks of complaining, but only of comforting us."

The children brightened up a little at these words, for their blithe spirits refused to be long downcast, especially when they felt sure of seeing the same bright, loving mother unchanged—all except Ruth; her sober face too well expressed her thoughts.

"Oh, father," broke in Hal, presently, "Jake Murphy says the fire has caught over at Liberty."

"Yes," replied his father, absently, "they are having a desperate struggle with the fires this summer."

Lou's great blue eyes had grown brighter and brighter while they were talking, and a pink spot glowed in each cheek as she asked, "Do you think it *could* get here?"

"No, I think not; the wind is decidedly westward, and the people of Liberty will probably take all possible measures for checking its progress."

Mr. Leonard sighed as he spoke, and he seemed to be looking straight through Ruth rather than at her. Perhaps he was wondering how the four bairns and the sick wife were to be fed and cared for all winter if no rain came to save his failing crops.

Just then a low call was heard for Lou.

"Yes, ma'am," answered the little girl, running to the foot of the stairs.

"Will thee bring mother a nice glass of cold water?"

"I will, mother," rang out Ruth's cheery voice; "I'm coming up anyway."

Ruth went out to the well with her tin water pail, that her mother might have a draught fresh and sparkling. As she lowered the bucket, peering down into the mossy depths, she noticed how low the water was—lower than she had ever seen it, for their well was never known to fail, and in these times of drought the neighbors from far and near drew their daily supply from Farmer Leonard's spring. "We'll have to be very careful of it," she thought, "or it will give out."

Ruth returned to the house with her cool refreshment, and taking one of the best goblets from the pantry, gave an extra polish with a fresh towel, and filled it with the water, "because it would taste so much better out of that."

"I thank thee, deary. How good it looks!" said the invalid, drinking eagerly. "Thee takes a deal of trouble for thy mother."

"And why shouldn't I? Thee is the best of mothers," responded the girl, tenderly hugging her.

Ruth now began to busy herself about the room. She wheeled out a big arm-chair by the window, padded it out with pillows into comfortable proportions, placed in front of it a little stuffed cricket, and threw a large soft shawl over the whole arrangement. She then gathered up all the stray dishes, placed everything in order, and carefully dusted the room.

A pair of loving eyes watched these operations, following every motion; but not a word was spoken, not a word of the doctor's decision, not a word of the life-long suffering in store.

"Now, mother," said Ruth at last, pausing in front of her, "we'll have thee up in a twinkling;" and with one strong motion she quickly lifted the slender form, so light in its best days, and so reduced by pain and suffering now, into the chair.

When she had settled her comfortably, and arranged the blinds so as to make a pleasant shade in the room, she brought the mate to the little stuffed cricket, and sat at her mother's side.

"What is it, daughter?—what troubles thee?"

"Oh! a great many things, mother," answered Ruth, laying her head on the sympathetic breast.

"Well, suppose thee tell mother the greatest trouble, and then the second, until thy mind is unburdened?" and the soft hands gently smoothed the brown hair.

"Well, the first is about thee;" and the tears would come in spite of her.

"Why, my dear child, do not grieve over that. Almost a year has gone by, and another will soon pass; and think what a calm, peaceful time I may have with so busy a little housekeeper to do everything."

"Ah! but that is just the trouble, mother," said Ruth, earnestly, as she lifted her tear-stained face. "I feel so good-for-nothing when I have only the same homely little duties every day. I do so long for a chance to be great and good."

"My daughter"—and Mrs. Leonard took both trembling hands in her own—"does thee know that the only way to be good and great is to do faithfully the work that is nearest thy hand? Let thy whole heart be drawn into each homely duty, and when an opportunity comes to do a great work, it will find thee ready."

Ruth said nothing, but the deep, strong look in the gray eyes expressed a firm resolve.

Presently there was a clatter of stout boots heard on the stairs.

"Harry is coming," said the mother with a smile.

In burst the noisy urchin, all aglow with excitement, his hair flying, eyes blazing, and breath so nearly spent that he could hardly speak.

"Don't you smell the smoke?" he gasped. "Something's up! Father—and a crowd of men—have gone off—into the woods—to see what's the matter. There's danger, I tell you. Come on, Scott, let's sit on the big post and watch."

"Thee'd better go down and see about it," said Mrs. Leonard to Ruth, as the two sat staring blankly into each other's faces.

"I will, mother," assented Ruth, recovering her wonted energy, as she ran down the stairs.

A strong wind greeted her upon opening the outer door, blowing into her face a sickening smell of burned wood. The whole sky seemed overcast, and a thick, heavy haze was settling down upon fields and buildings as far as the eye could reach.

"Harry! Harry!" she called, excitedly, "where's father?"

"Gone to the woods, I told you. Oh, there he comes!" and Hal peered into the gloom as he looked in the direction of the woods.

Ruth saw a dark moving object coming toward them. She waited for no second look, but sped away like the wind into the nearest field.

"Oh, father, what's happened?" she cried, breathlessly, running up to him and catching his arm as she turned to keep pace with his long strides toward the house.

"We're going to burn out," he answered, with set teeth, "and there's no time to lose. Go get your mother ready to move, while I harness the horses. We must reach the lake within an hour, or—"

"How can we?" uttered Ruth, aghast. "Ten miles!"

"It must be done. Quick, daughter!"

The girl needed no further bidding, but ran homeward, calling to Hal as she passed, and charging him to keep near the house with Scott.

Ruth made straight for the store-room, and filling her arms with a pile of blankets, she carried them to the door and threw them on the ground, ready to spread in the wagon. She then hastened to her mother's room, and found her pale and composed, trying to quiet Lou, who was sobbing hysterically.

"Mother, we're gone. Not a thing can be saved. Father's getting the wagon ready to drive us to the lake;" and Ruth began to dress her mother, slipping on a loose wrapper, and covering her with

shawl after shawl as a protection from the scorching air.

"Try and gather up some of the clothing, Ruth, if there's time," said Mrs. Leonard, controlling herself into calmness.

Ruth obeyed, pulled a sheet from the bed, and crowded into it such articles as were nearest at hand.

"Oh, mother!" screamed Lou, and hid her face, as a blinding smoke burst into the room enveloping the place in darkness.

"We must go," Ruth, cried, as she snatched her mother up in her arms, and stepped firmly toward the door, clasping her burden tight to her breast, and followed by Lou, clinging frantically to her skirts.

Hurriedly Ruth groped her way down the staircase and through the lower rooms, stumbling over the furniture, until they reached the scorching blast without. Upon emerging from the house a burning shower of cinders met them.

Not a sign of father or the wagon.

"Come, put your dress over your head, Lou," panted Ruth, whose hands were smarting with pain.

There was not a moment to be lost. They must flee somewhere, for the house was already ablaze. An awful yellow glare lit up the dense darkness, and on every side the crash of falling trees filled the air with a terrible din. On they rushed through the blistering heat, scarcely knowing where, Ruth still bearing her precious burden, and the children clinging to her in wild despair.

How long they pursued this headlong flight no one knew. All sense of time was lost; it might have been minutes, or it might have been hours. Suddenly Ruth lost her balance. She gave utterance to one piercing shriek, but she never let go her burden, and then she slid down, down, down. The terrified children screamed as they rolled over and over, and then all was silence and darkness.

Ruth was the first to recover.

"Mother?"

"I'm safe. The children?"

"Oh, where are we?" moaned the little ones, creeping on their hands and knees toward the familiar voices. They managed to reach the sheltering embrace of mother, who lay unhurt amid her wrappings just as she had slipped from the stanch arms that saved her life.

Ruth began to feel around; for even the ghastly light of the flames had vanished, and not an object was visible in the thick, deep gloom. Brambles and briers and low bushes upon all sides. With each turn the dry twigs and leaves crackled, and in attempting to move, the girl found her clothing caught upon thorns that projected on all sides. It was with difficulty that she managed to extricate herself, bruised and benumbed as she was, but it was necessary to explore further. The ground felt hard and clayey, and was covered with stones. Turning halfway round, Ruth found a little clear space, and creeping forward, soon came to rising ground. Catching hold of a bush, she pulled herself a little way up the slope, when an idea of their situation suddenly flashed upon her.

"Why, we're in the creek—the dry creek down by the meadow lot," she called out. "Where are you all? I've lost you."

"Here," replied her mother's voice not three yards away. "Is Scott with thee? Harry and Lou are safe."

"No," answered Ruth, aghast, hastening with all possible speed to her mother's side.

"Where is the child?" she cried, immediately calling aloud with all her strength, "Scott! Scott!"

But no answer.

"He must have hidden somewhere when the darkness came," was the mother's despairing conclusion.

"The root-house!" Ruth's words told the awful story.

"If I *could* save him!" And with a silent prayer for strength, she once more dashed into the stifling smoke.

Hour after hour crept by; it seemed to the terrified children as if they must have sat there for days; and they were so hungry! and Ruth never would come!

Presently, after long waiting, the darkness began to lift somewhat, and they could see each other's faces. Little by little the gloom cleared away until the whole atmosphere was of a dusky hue. And still they waited. At length, starting up with an exclamation of joy as rapid footsteps approached, they heard their father's voice.

"Ruth? Hal?"

"Here," roared Hal, starting to his feet.

In a moment more Mr. Leonard bounded down the steep bank of the creek, and with him Jake Murphy, who had started from the village to warn Mr. Leonard, reaching the farm just as that first overwhelming darkness dropped upon the village.

They had found shelter in the old well, for Mr. Leonard was overtaken in his preparations for flight, and could not reach the house before it burst into flames. When the crisis was past, almost wild with grief and despair, he commenced a search for wife and children, fearing at every step to come upon their lifeless bodies. For a moment he stood overcome with thankfulness as he found them unharmed.

But two were missing. Mrs. Leonard hurriedly told of little Scott's disappearance, and of Ruth's effort to save him.

The two men hastened to the root-house. It was still standing, though blackened and charred, and no sign of life appeared. The door was tightly closed, and upon opening it a sight met the father's eye which almost overpowered the strong man. There lay Ruth, white and still, tightly clasping the little fellow to her bosom.

It was but the work of a moment to carry them out of the dark building. Both were unconscious, though they bore few traces of the fire. Might there not yet be a chance of life?

Quickly the men bore the motionless forms to the creek. All the remedies which they could obtain were applied, but it seemed in vain; the loving ones could do little but watch and wait.

At last Ruth stirred, and slowly opened her eyes. The brave heart once more began to beat, though for many a long, weary day the blistered hands and arms refused to move. But Ruth was spared.

Little Scott lay there for hours, until it seemed that the family must lose their baby, when he wonderingly gazed around upon the anxious group, and inquired, "Did you try to cook me for dinner?"

All the pent-up feelings found vent in a tearful laugh, and then the laugh turned to joy, and the joy to thanksgiving.

When the flaming hurricane had swept onward in its mad course of destruction, and the sun, which had risen in such fierce glory, sent a last sickly glimmer through the murky air, it revealed the little village of Greenville a waste of smoking ruins. But the fire had mercifully stopped upon reaching Farmer Leonard's grassy meadow, and thus had the fugitives in the creek been saved.

The strong men set to work with a will. It took but a few hours to raise a little shed for protection; and day after day his prospects brightened, as the timely aid and sympathy of friends helped him to rebuild his ruined home.

It would have been hard to find a happier household than this reunited family. Slowly strength returned to Ruth's wounded arms, and a sweet peace shone through the gray eyes as she once more became able to enjoy the blessings which had so nearly been taken from her.

Her great opportunity had come, and it had found her ready.



"WAIT FOR PUSSIE, FIDO!"

HOW A BOY WAS HIRED OUT, AND WHAT CAME OF IT.

BY GEORGE CARY EGGLESTON.

When Michael Angelo was twelve years of age, although he had had no instruction in art, he did a piece of work which greatly pleased the painter Dominico Ghirlandajo. This artist at once declared that here was a lad of genius, who must quit his studies, and become a painter.

This was what the little Michael most wished to do, but he had no hope that his father would listen for a moment to the suggestion. His father, Ludovico Buonarotti, was a distinguished man in the state, and held art and artists in contempt. He had planned a great political career for his boy, as the boy knew very well.

Ghirlandajo was enthusiastic, however, and in company with the lad he at once visited Ludovico, and asked him to place Michael in his studio.

Ludovico was very angry, saying that he wished his son to become a prominent man in society and politics, not a dauber and a mason; but when he found that young Michael was determined to be an artist or nothing, he gave way, though most ungraciously. He would not say that he consented to place his son with Ghirlandajo; he would not admit that the study of art was study, or the studio of an artist anything but a shop. He said to the artist: "I give up my son to you. He shall be your apprentice or your servant, as you please, for three years, and you must pay me twenty-four florins for his services."

In spite of the insulting words and the insulting terms, Michael Angelo consented thus to be hired out as a servant to the artist, who should have been paid by his father for teaching him. He had to endure much, indeed, besides the anger and contempt of his father, who forbade him even to visit his house, and utterly disowned him. His fellow-pupils were jealous of his ability, and ill-treated him constantly, one of them going so far as to break his nose with a blow.

When Michael Angelo had been with Ghirlandajo about two years, he went one day to the Gardens of St. Mark, where the Prince Lorenzo de' Medici—who was the great patron of art in Florence—had established a rich museum of art-works at great expense. One of the workmen in the garden gave the boy leave to try his hand at copying some of the sculptures there, and Michael, who had hitherto studied only painting, was glad of a chance to experiment with the chisel, which he preferred to the brush. He chose for his model an ancient figure of a faun, which was somewhat mutilated. The mouth, indeed, was entirely broken off, but the boy was very self-reliant, and this did not trouble him. He worked day after day at the piece, creating a mouth for it of his own imagining, with the lips parted in laughter, and the teeth displayed.

When he had finished and was looking at his work, a man standing near asked if he might offer a criticism.

"Yes," answered the boy, "if it is a just one."

"Of that you shall be the judge," said the man.

"Very well. What is it?"

"The forehead of your faun is old, but the mouth is young. See, it has a full set of perfect teeth. A faun so old as this one is would not have perfect teeth."

The lad admitted the justice of the criticism, and proceeded to remedy the defect by chipping away two or three of the teeth, and chiselling the gums so as to give them a shrivelled appearance.

The next morning, when Michael went to remove his faun from the garden, it was gone. He searched everywhere for it, but without success. Finally, seeing the man who had made the suggestion about the teeth, he asked him if he knew where it was.

"Yes," replied the man, "and if you will follow me I'll show you where it is."

"Will you give it back to me? I made it, and have a right to it."

"Oh, if you must have it, you shall."

With that he led the way into the palace of the Prince, and there, among the most precious works of art in the collection, stood the faun. The young sculptor cried out in alarm, declaring that the Prince Lorenzo would never forgive the introduction of so rude a piece of work among his treasures of sculpture. To his astonishment the man declared that he was himself the Prince Lorenzo de' Medici, and that he set the highest value upon this work.

"I am your protector and friend," he added. "Henceforth you shall be counted as my son, for you are destined to become one of the great masters of art."

This was overwhelming good fortune. Lorenzo de' Medici was a powerful nobleman, known far and wide to be a most expert judge of works of art. His approval was in itself fame and fortune.

Filled with joy, the lad went straightway to his father's house, which he had been forbidden to enter, and forcing his way into Ludovico's presence, told him what had happened. The father refused to believe the good news until Michael led him into Lorenzo's presence.

When the Prince, by way of emphasizing his good-will, offered Ludovico any post he might choose, he asked for a very modest place indeed, saying, with bitter contempt, that it was good enough "for the father of a mason."

THE HARDEST TUG OF ALL.

A BAVARIAN STORY.

BY DAVID KER.

The sun was just beginning to sink over the beautiful hills of Southern Bavaria. A big red-bearded man, with arms bare to the elbow, stood at the door of a little mountain inn upon one of the higher slopes, watching, with his broad brown hand arched over his eyes, a group of five men who had just issued from the mass of dark green pines that covered the crest of the opposite ridge.

"One, two, three, four, five," counted the landlord. "They're all there but Hermann; but they've found no game, I can see. Where can Hermann be, I wonder? *He* won't come back empty-handed, I'll be bound."

"Hermann's late," said one of the foresters, "but I warrant he'll be ready for his supper when he does come."

"And well he may, if he has found any game, for I can tell you, lads, that to carry a quarter of venison from the Riesenberg to my door, on a roasting day like this, would be a job for Strong Schalk himself."

"And who may Strong Schalk be?" asked a sunburned peddler who was sitting beside the window.

"*Who?*" echoed the landlord, staring; "why, brother, you must be a stranger in these parts to ask that. But if you want to know about him, all you've got to do is to go down to Kreuzweg town yonder and ask any man, woman, or child you may meet about 'Strong Schalk,' and they'll tell you something that'll astonish you."

"And if that's not enough," struck in one of the hunters, with a grin, "let him go into Schalk's shop and challenge him to wrestle, and he'll be astonished still more—eh, Father Baum?"

"Ugh! don't talk of it!" grunted the landlord, making a wry face; "you make my fingers ache with the very recollection."

"Why, he must be a perfect giant!" cried the peddler, who had been listening open-mouthed.

"No, that's the strangest part of it. He's no bigger than another man—rather smaller, in fact—and a tailor into the bargain; and yet he can do feats worthy of Hans Stronghand in the story."

"Of whom are you speaking?" asked a deep voice from the door.

"Of Strong Schalk, the tailor of Kreuzweg, Friend Hermann," answered the landlord, shaking hands with the new-comer, a powerful young fellow, with an air which showed that he had no small idea of his own importance.

"The mischief take Strong Schalk!" cried Hermann, angrily. "I'm sick of his very name;" and with the full power of his mighty voice he rolled out the song:

"There were a host of tailors,
Brave fellows one and all;
Then drank they, all the ninety,

Ay, nine times nine-and-ninety,
Out of a thimble small.

thirst,
"And when this draught had quenched their

Then weigh themselves would they;
Yet could not all the ninety,
Ay, nine times nine-and-ninety,
A single goat upweigh.

"Then homeward trudged they all—but lo!
The door was locked within;
Then hopped they, all the ninety,
Ay, nine times nine-and-ninety,
Right through the key-hole, in."

The boisterous chorus had hardly died away, when a quiet but unmistakably firm voice was heard to say:

"Stop there! enough of this!"

All turned with a start, and saw that the silent stranger near the door had risen from his seat.

"Gentlemen," he continued, amid the universal hush of amazement, "I must tell you that *I* am a tailor, and that I object to hear any man speak ill of my trade."

"Do you, really?" cried Hermann, with a laugh. "Well, then, I must tell you that you will either keep a civil tongue in your head, or I'll have to show you the difference between an honest forester and a fellow who lives on cloth clippings and ends of thread."

"Better live on them than on stolen game," retorted the unknown, with biting contempt.

At this last insinuation, honest Hermann—who certainly was said to be not overparticular whether the deer that he shot belonged to the park or to the forest—lost patience altogether, and laid his hand upon his long hunting-knife. But instantly the landlord thrust himself between them.

"Halt there, lad—no bare blades in *my* house, if you please. I'll tell you a better way to settle it than that. You know our old Bavarian fashion; when two young fellows want to try each other's strength, they join hands and see which can tug the other across the line. Clear a space there, and let us see which is the best man."

The tables and benches were pushed back, a line chalked on the floor, and Hermann and the stranger, seizing each other's hands in a strong grasp, stood foot to foot, awaiting the signal.

Now for the first time it broke upon the foresters that their champion might not have such an easy victory after all, for the supple vigor of the stranger's movements, and the firmness with which he planted his feet, showed that Hermann had his work cut out for him. Hermann himself, feeling the iron grasp of the unknown's long bony fingers, began to think so too; but could any man, much less a tailor, be a match for *him*? Absurd! And he began with a pull that ought to have ended the whole business at once; but somehow it didn't.

Then, stimulated by his comrades' shouts, Hermann put forth all his strength, tugging as if he were uprooting a tree, till the sweat hung in big drops on his forehead, and the veins of his hands stood

out like cords. But though the unknown was sorely shaken, across the line he would not come; and at length Hermann paused, exhausted.

Then the watching eyes around saw the stranger's arms stiffen suddenly, and Hermann's huge frame bend slowly forward. Frantically he struggled, but his strength was spent, and forward he slid, inch by inch. Just on the chalk line he made a final effort, and stood firm for an instant; but now the stranger exerted all his force in turn, and pulled him over the line with such a tremendous tug that they both rolled on the floor together.

"Comrade!" shouted the hunters, crowding round the conqueror, "you've done what none of *us* could ever do. Tell us your name, that we may remember it."

"My parents named me Ferdinand," answered the stranger, with a queer little mocking smile, "but of late folks have taken to calling me Strong Schalk!"

"Strong Schalk!" echoed Hermann, starting from the seat upon which he had sunk dejectedly. "Shake hands, lad; it would have broken my heart to be beaten by a tailor, but I don't mind a bit being beaten by *you*. Come, let us be friends!"

And from that day forth the two men were the best friends imaginable.

HOW TO MAKE A TOY CANOE.

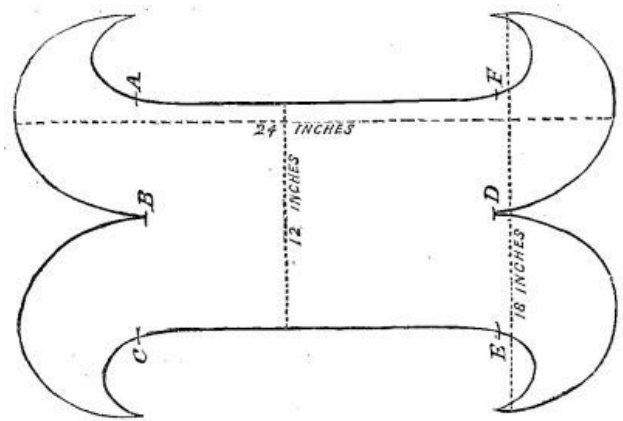
BY C. W. FISHER.

The building of a birch-bark canoe of sufficient size and well enough made for actual use would rather tax the mechanical skill of most boys; but with no better tool than a jackknife, and with a little ingenuity, a small model may be easily made.

There are few localities where the material—the white birch—can not be obtained. The dimensions given here are those of one which hangs above us as we write, and are only given to make the explanations clearer. Of course it can be built of any size, and the young builder may make such other changes in its construction as taste or necessity may suggest.

A tree not more than eight inches through furnishes the best quality of bark, flexible enough to be readily handled, and tough enough to be durable. Woodsmen tell us that in stripping it we should avoid "girdling" the tree—that is, removing the bark the entire distance round—but should leave a piece several inches wide, that the flow of sap shall not be wholly stopped. Having determined upon the size of the canoe (ours is twenty-four inches long), select a part of the tree as free from knots and imperfections as possible. Make two horizontal cuts for three-fourths of the girth, and about two feet apart. Connect these by two vertical cuts at their ends, and peel off the piece between the cuts. This will be of an oblong shape, and about twenty-four inches by eighteen. The bark consists of many layers, and the outside one should be pulled off and discarded, those beneath being much handsomer in color and finish.

The diagram shows the shape in which the piece is to be first marked with pencil, and then cut with knife or shears. The edges from B round to A and C, and from D round to E and F, are next to be joined, and sewed with an X stitch in colored silk or thread. The natural curve of the bark shapes an excellent bottom to the little craft, and a gunwale, which prevents splitting, and gives a more ship-shape appearance to it, is easily prepared by taking a thinner piece than that of which the body of the canoe is made, cutting two strips an inch wide and long enough to extend from A to F, folding them lengthwise, and stitching them as before, crease uppermost, over the edges. A better curve, and perhaps added strength, may be secured by running a small wire under the crease, but this is both troublesome and unnecessary. Two or three thwarts can be made without difficulty from a bit of soft pine, and held in place just under the gunwale by small brads.



Two coats of thin shellac give a beautiful, and lasting finish to the work, and one is really surprised at the pretty result of so slight an expenditure of time and labor. Suspended from a hook or an archway by bright ribbons attached to the prow, stern, and sides, and filled with dried grapes, or,

better still, lined with a shaped tin vessel containing moss and planted with ferns, the canoe becomes a graceful household ornament, as well as a charming reminder of a summer's holiday.

OUR BULL-FIGHT.

BY JIMMY BROWN.

I'm going to stop improving my mind. It gets me into trouble all the time. Grown-up folks can improve their minds without doing any harm, for nobody ever tells them that their conduct is such, and that there isn't the least excuse in the world for them: but just as sure as a boy tries to improve his mind, especially with animals, he gets into dreadful difficulties.

There was a man came to our town to lecture a while ago. He had been a great traveller, and knew all about Rome and Niagara Falls and the North Pole, and such places, and father said: "Now, Jimmy, here's an opportunity for you to learn something and improve your mind go and take your mother and do take an interest in something besides games."

Well, I went to the lecture. The man told all about the Australian savages and their boomerangs. He showed us a boomerang, which is a stick with two legs, and an Australian will throw it at a man, and it will go and hit him, and come back of its own accord. Then he told us about the way the Zulus throw their assegais—that's the right way to spell it—and spear an Englishman that is morn ten rods away from them. Then he showed a long string with a heavy lead ball on each end, and said the South Americans would throw it at a wild horse, and it would wind around the horse's legs, and tie itself into a bow-knot, and then the South Americans would catch the horse. But the best of all was the account of a bull-fight which he saw in Spain, with the Queen sitting on a throne, and giving a crown of evergreens to the chief bull-fighter. He said that bull-fighting was awfully cruel, and that he told us about it so that we might be thankful that we are so much better than those dreadful Spanish people, who will watch a bull-fight all day, and think it real fun.

The next day I told Mr. Travers about the boomerang, and he said it was all true. Once there was an Australian savage in a circus, and he got angry, and he threw his boomerang at a man who was in the third story of a hotel. The boomerang went down one street and up another, and into the hotel door, and upstairs, and knocked the man on the head, and came back the same way right into the Australian savage's hand.

I was so anxious to show father that I had listened to the lecture that I made a boomerang just like the one the lecturer had. When it was done, I went out into the back yard, and slung it at a cat on the roof of our house. It never touched the cat, but it went right through the dining-room window, and gave Mr. Travers an awful blow in the eye, besides hitting Sue on the nose. It stopped right there in the dining-room, and never came back to me at all, and I don't believe a word the lecturer said about it. I don't feel courage to tell what father said about it.

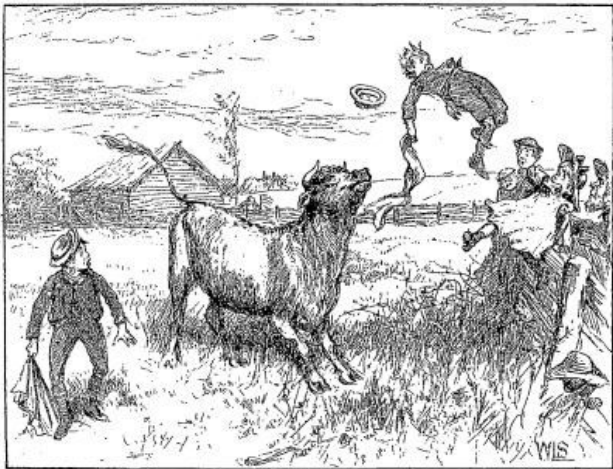
Then I tried to catch Mr. Thompson's dog, that lives next door to us, with two lead balls tied on the ends of a long string. I didn't hit the dog any more than I did the cat, but I didn't do any harm except to Mrs. Thompson's cook, and she ought to be thankful that it was only her arm, for the doctor said that if the balls had hit her on the head they would have broken it, and the consequences might have been serious.

It was a good while before I could find anything to make an assegai out of; but after hunting all over the house, I came across a lovely piece of bamboo about ten feet long, and just as light as a feather. Then I got a big knife blade that hadn't any handle to it, and that had been lying in father's tool chest for ever so long, and fastened it on the end of the bamboo. You wouldn't believe how

splendidly I could throw that assegai, only the wind would take it, and you couldn't tell when you threw it where it would bring up. I don't see how the Zulus ever manage to hit an Englishman; but Mr. Travers says that the Englishmen are all so made that you can't very well miss them. And then perhaps the Zulus, when they want to hit them, aim at something else. One day I was practicing with the assegai at our barn door, making believe that it was an Englishman, when Mr. Carruthers, the butcher, drove by, and the assegai came down and went through his foot, and pinned it to the wagon. But he didn't see me, and I guess he got it out after a while, though I never saw it again.

But what the lecturer taught us about bull-fights was worse than anything else. Tom McGinnis's father has a terrible bull in the pasture, and Tom and I agreed that we'd have a bull-fight, only, of course, we wouldn't hurt the bull. All we wanted to do was to show our parents how much we had learned about the geography and habits of the Spaniards.

Tom McGinnis's sister Jane, who is twelve years old, and thinks she knows everything, said she'd be the Queen of Spain, and give Tom and me evergreen wreaths. I got an old red curtain out of the dining-room, and divided it with Tom, so that we could wave it in the bull's face. When a bull runs after a bull-fighter, the other bull-fighter just waves his red rag, and the bull goes for him and lets the first bull-fighter escape. The lecturer said that there wasn't any danger so long as one fellow would always wave a red rag when the bull ran after the other fellow, and of course we believed him.



**"HE WENT TWENTY FEET RIGHT UP
INTO THE AIR."**

Pretty nearly all the school came down to the pasture to see our bull-fight. The Queen of Spain sat on the fence, because there wasn't any other throne, and the rest of the fellows and girls stood behind the fence. The bull was pretty savage; but Tom and I had our red rags, and we weren't afraid of him.

As soon as we went into the pasture the bull came for me, with his head down, and bellowing as if he was out of his mind. Tom rushed up and waved his red rag, and the bull stopped running after me, and went after Tom, just as the lecturer said he would.

I know I ought to have waved my red rag, so as to rescue Tom, but I was so interested that I forgot all about it, and the bull caught up with Tom. I should think he went twenty feet right

up into the air, and as he came down he hit the Queen of Spain, and knocked her about six feet right against Mr. McGinnis, who had come down to the pasture to stop the fight.

The doctor says they'll all get well, though Tom's legs are all broke, and his sister's shoulder is out of joint, and Mr. McGinnis has got to get a new set of teeth. Father didn't do a thing to me—that is, with anything—but he talked to me till I made up my mind that I'd never try to learn anything from a lecturer again, not even if he lectures about Indians and scalping-knives.

THE OLD MILL.

Oh, the merry mill-stream it is sparkling and bright
As it runs down the hill-side in shadow and light;
Now it circles in pools, and now throws a cascade,
And laughs out in high glee at the leap it has made.

With its ripples are mingled on many a day
The shouts and the laughter of children at play;
And many a picnic is joyously spread
On its banks, where the green branches wave overhead.

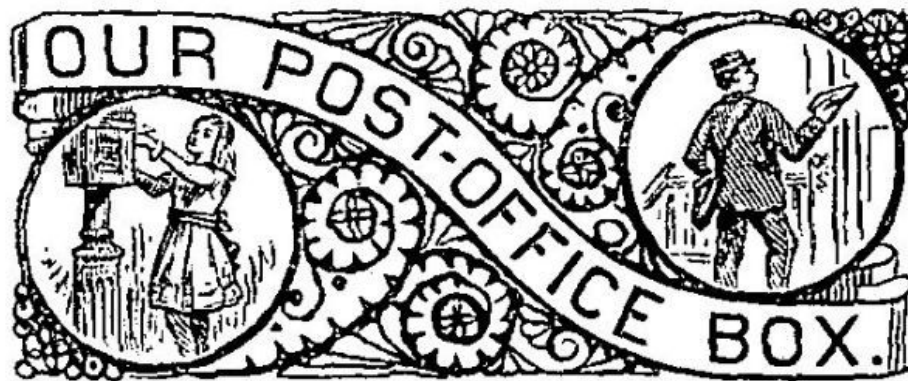
But the jolliest place is the old ruined mill,
With the great wooden water-wheel, solemn and still;
Once it whirled round and round with the rush of the

stream,

Till a new mill was built to be driven by steam.

Now the children climb over its big wooden spokes
But the wheel into motion they never can coax;
They may clamber and push, they may tug with a zest,
They can not awake the old giant from rest.

And perhaps, if it only could speak, it would say:
"After all the hard labor I've done in my day,
It is pleasant to know that the children may still
Find their happiest times in the old ruined mill."



Are you sorry, little folks, that your vacation weeks are flying away so rapidly? They fairly race, says Lottie C., when the second week of August has come. So they do; but I am sure Lottie would not like a whole year without school or studies. Fred H. is making a collection of butterflies, and finds the occupation very interesting. Etta R. has never until this summer seen the ocean; she likes to hear the roar of the breakers, and to watch the great waves rolling in upon the shore. Tom P., whose mother has been ill, has been taking care of her, there being no girls at home. Well done, Tom. The boy who is kind and thoughtful in his manner to mother is manly, and on the way to make a gentleman. That is what a gentleman is, boys—just a *gentle man*. Think of it. Pauline C. has been reading Mrs. Browning's poems in her vacation. She has spent her time very wisely. And you, Edward and Priscy, Charles and Kate, Theodore and Isabel, Lulu and Minnie, and all the dear girls and boys who come clustering around me even in my dreams, I am glad when I think how

busy and bright you are, and when I hear how you are trying every day to do right and be good. Our Post-office Box has been crowded lately with your sparkling letters, but it is very elastic; so, little Sunbeams, keep on shining.

ORION,

ILLINOIS.

I am a little boy seven years old. I have a canary-bird named Dicky, who sings the day long. I had two pet rabbits, named Bunny and Snowflake. On the Fourth of July a dog caught Snowflake and killed him. I felt very bad about it. Papa buried it in the yard, and I am going to put a head-stone at its grave. Papa says a neat board, with "Snowflake" on it, will do. I have two little chickens named Specky and Blackie; and mamma got another rabbit, and his name is Darling. He is as white as snow, and his eyes are red as fire. I feed them on clover, bread, cabbage, and some nice tender grass. I can read in the Second Reader. I am going to school this winter. I can print on my slate. Do you like to get letters from little boys? If you do, I guess I will write another some time. Good-by. I like "Mr. Stubbs's Brother" ever so much.

S. P. D.

Poor little Snowflake! If I were you, dear, I would plant a rose-bush beside his grave. What dreadful things have happened to some of our pets! Of course I like to hear from little boys, and you must write again when you are in the Third Reader.

PHILADELPHIA,

PENNSYLVANIA.

I want to tell you about a smart little girl named Hebe at our school. She is only six years old. One day Miss S. said, "What does c-a-n-e spell, Hebe?" Hebe said she didn't know. Then Miss S. said, "What do gentlemen walk with?" and Hebe said, "Ladies." Another time one of the teachers was hearing her spell, and she couldn't spell one word right; but at last she did. The teacher asked why she didn't spell it that way at first, and she said, "Oh, I knew it all the time, only I was just hugging."

LUCY P. W.

What a droll little scholar! She must make the class quite merry.

WATERLOO,

IOWA.

I have taken YOUNG PEOPLE from the first number, and have read the letters in the Post-office Box with great interest, but have never before ventured to write one myself; but now I thought I would write and tell you about my trip on the Fourth of July across Iowa. Monday evening I went alone to Cedar Rapids, and in the morning papa took me in his mail-car, and I rode with him to Council Bluffs over the Chicago and Northwestern Railroad. It is a beautiful prairie country, with occasional belts of timber on the streams. We everywhere saw splendid farms, with fine houses and barns and large herds. We passed through an Indian reservation near Tama City. The Indian men were out with their fish-poles and guns, and their squaws were hoeing in the fields, while the boys, like true American boys, were playing with fire-crackers. We passed, near Ames, the State Agricultural College and Farm. Marshalltown and Boone are thriving towns on this route. At Boone we came to Iowa's vast coal field, and we passed several mines; it is "soft" coal. Near Moingona I saw the little house where Kate Shelley lives, and crossed the long bridge that she crept over at night and in a terrible storm to warn a coming train of danger. The last twenty miles of our trip are the most interesting. On the right are the "bottom" lands of the Missouri, with the highlands of Nebraska in the distance. On our left are the "bluffs," rising perhaps two hundred feet, and taking many curious shapes. Once we came in sight of the great river, and I can now understand why it is called the "Big Muddy." At nearly every station on the route the people were out to celebrate the Fourth; flags were flying, bands playing, and the small boys and fire-crackers were everywhere. I hope they all had a pleasant time; I know I did. As I have never seen a letter in the YOUNG PEOPLE from Waterloo, I hope you will like mine well enough to print it.

MARY F. M.

We are all glad when our correspondents describe their pleasant trips, and tell what they have seen when away from home. I think Mary's letter shows that she took notice of what was worth looking at in her Fourth-of-July journey across Iowa.

OHIO.

BRECKSVILLE,

I was ten years old December 20, 1881, and live in Cleveland, but I am staying here for my vacation. It is a very pretty country village. I like very much to ride on the hay wagon, but the hay is damp to-day, and can not be taken in. I am in the Fourth Reader at school. I would have been in the Fifth, only, when I came from Brooklyn, New York, I was put back on account of the difference in the schools. I like the West better than the East. I am getting stouter every day. I have a brother seven years old, named Sumner.

LINCOLN S.

I think it is great fun to ride on top of a load of hay. It makes one feel quite proud to be so high up in the world.

PEEKSKILL,

NEW YORK.

I have taken HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE a year and a half, and like it very much. My home is on the State Camp Ground, but we moved away when the soldiers came there. We moved the 16th of June; I was sorry to come away. I do not like it where we live now; it is a little cooped-up place on the edge of Peekskill. I am the only girl of the family, but I have four brothers. The week of the Fourth of July we all went over on a high hill overlooking the camp ground to see the fire-works. We can not hear the music very plainly, because of the hill in front of us. I have been over to the camp six times since we moved. We have a pet cat that can catch fish. One day last summer two of my brothers were out rowing in a boat, and the cat was with them, and when they were quite a way out in the creek she jumped overboard and swam ashore.

A. G. C.

Pussy was an exception to cats in general. They seldom like to wet their dainty feet. It must be very pleasant to have four brothers to take care of and pet their only sister. I hope yours are very fond of you, and that you are kind and good to them.

BRIGHTON,

SUSSEX, ENGLAND.

I am an English boy nine years old. I have a sister named Eva; she is four years old; and I have also a jolly little brother named Harold, and he is two. I have only one pet, a canary, whose name is Dick; he sings very loud. A friend of my father's, who used to go to school with him, lives in Philadelphia, and he sends me the numbers of YOUNG PEOPLE every month. I do enjoy reading them, and I think Jimmy Brown's stories are capital. When I went to the Zoological Gardens in London I saw Jumbo have his bath; his keeper had to give him a good scolding before he would go in. It was so deep he dived down quite out of sight. I hope you will print this. I have just got over an illness, and can not go out much. Good-by.

PERCY

WILLIAM S.

By this time Percy is, I hope, quite well and strong again. We like to receive pleasant words from little friends across the water.

SHOPIERE,

WISCONSIN.

This is a very small place, though it is very pleasant. I have never seen any letters from this place, so mine will be the first. I have a pet sheep named Nig; like "Mary's lamb," it followed me to school one day. It was a warm day, and I had gone to school in the afternoon. Mamma was home alone, and she heard Nig bleating as though something were the matter, and she

went out and found him panting as if he were very warm; so she let him through into the yard (never thinking that the gate was open), and he began to eat, so she did not watch him. But the first she knew he was gone. One of the girls at school saw him, and knew he was mine, and began to laugh. The teacher asked her what she was laughing at, and she said, "Lula's lamb is here." I went out, and found him walking around, trying to find me. I took him home then. I have two other sheep and two lambs. I am taking up a great deal of room, but I want to tell you about thirteen chickens I had last summer. Papa gave them to me for taking care of the other hens. I soon got them tame, and I could take corn and shell it over myself, and they would scramble over me, sometimes pecking at my teeth. I sold them for twelve shillings. I have a brother De Witt who is fifteen. I am twelve.

LULA H. P.

So Lula's lamb was like Mary's, and "it made the children laugh and play to see a lamb at school." Why did you not give him a prettier name, dear? You are very kind to your pets, and that makes them so gentle. You must have been as pretty as a picture, with the little chicks scrambling over you for the kernels of corn.

OMEGA P. O.,

MADISON PARISH, LOUISIANA.

I'm a little boy six years old, and I take HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE. I'm more interested in Jimmy Brown's stories and the little letters than in anything else, though I like "Mr. Stubbs's Brother." My papa is on the railroad in Arkansas, and will be home to see us soon. He says there are ever so many ticks in the pine woods. I feed and water the chickens, and sweep the hall and gallery every day. I will tell you of the overflow in my next letter. I've got a buddie George; he lives with his auntie May, and I live with my aunt Leila, as my own mamma is dead, and my papa married my aunt. With many good wishes to Toby Tyler, your little friend,

JAMES

HOWARD R.

I hope none of those annoying little pests called ticks will fasten on those of my children who live in the Southern pine regions. I know all about them, and they are really "horrid," to borrow a word which is used sometimes when it ought not to be.

JERSEY CITY

HEIGHTS, NEW JERSEY.

I am eleven years old. I have just been reading HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE, and think the letter that Ninetta wrote is very nice. I have no pets except a darling little brother three years old, and he says he is going to write you a letter. I have just learned how to make feather-edge, and I have made half a yard to-day. I have taken HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE ever since it was published, and I think it is the nicest paper I ever read, or ever expect to read. I hope this letter

is not too long, and will be printed, as I would like to surprise some of my friends who take the paper. On the following page you will see my brother's letter.

Do you know, dear child, that you forgot to sign your name, and so I do not know who my little correspondent is, although she is much brighter than I, for I have tried in vain to learn to make that puzzling trimming called feather-edge. Please kiss little brother for his letter.

OHIO.

OXFORD,

I am a little girl eight years old. I have two little kittens, one black and one white. I have a dog, and his name is Fido. We have a dove, and she has two little doves in the nest in the cedar-tree. We have every HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE that has been printed. I play with my brother Sam, who is seven now, and we have two velocipedes.

LIVY R.

PENNSYLVANIA.

PHILADELPHIA,

My mamma writes this for me, because I can not write very well, and I would not like to trouble you to read a letter from me. I have been going to Kindergarten for three or four years, and am just learning to write now. We have been taking HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE a long time, and we have it complete, excepting the first seventeen numbers, and No. 33. Now we want to know if we can get those numbers, in order to have them bound, and as we have tried unsuccessfully to procure them in Philadelphia, we know of no other way to find out about it than by applying to you; and if you will kindly answer through the Post-office Box, we will be very greatly indebted to you.

I have a pug dog and two kittens, and they are like the "Happy Family." We think a great deal of HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE, and I read it to my little sister.

JOHN M. F.

No. 33 can be furnished by the Messrs. Harper & Brothers, but not the earlier numbers of YOUNG PEOPLE. Possibly some little reader may have duplicates; and if so, will he or she notify the Postmistress on John's behalf?

NEW YORK.

WINDHAM,

I thought I would write you a little letter to put in Our Post-office Box. I have a little candy store in my papa's office all my own. I pay for the candy, and have all the profits. It is vacation now, but I study at home. This village (Windham) is situated on an elevation of over one thousand five hundred feet above the level of the sea. Papa has one hundred and fifty-five hives of bees, and I am going to help him take care of them. We carefully take the comb out of the hives, put it in a revolving cylinder, turn the crank, and the honey flies out of the comb against the side of the cylinder; then it is strained, and is ready for use. Then we replace the comb for the bees to refill again. This we do several times in a season.

DORVILLE C.

So you are a merchant, dear, and carry on a business all alone. Well, I hope you keep your accounts with care, and that you will put your earnings to some good use. Your description of the bees, and the way their honey is extracted from the comb, is very interesting.

Where the blackbird sings the latest,
Where the hawthorn blooms the sweetest,
Where the nestlings chirp and flee,
That's the way for Willie and me.

Where the mowers mow the cleanest,
Where the hay lies thick and greenest,
There to track the homeward bee,
That's the way for Willie and me.

EUREKA,

MISSOURI.

I am a little boy seven years old. My name is Early. My mamma, my sister Hattie (who is eight years old), and I spend our summers out here on grandpa's farm. I have a pony to ride; his name is Brigham. I made \$1.45 carrying water for grandpa's hands in harvest; had two demijohns slung across the pony in front of the saddle. I have a goat and wagon, but Billy is so big and strong that he runs away, and dumps me in the ditch. I have two dogs, Nip and Aleck. Aleck is a shepherd dog; Nip is a little fellow, but he runs awful fast when he gets after a rabbit. I have lots of fun out here—so many peaches and apples, and lots of young ducks and chickens. Papa comes out every Saturday evening, and we go to the train to meet him. We have such a nice Sunday-school in the little district school-house right at the corner of our orchard. We go up there to Sunday-school in the afternoon, and have such nice songs to sing. Hattie picked two gallons of dewberries, sold them for forty cents, and gave the money to help pay for the organ. I want papa to let me be a farmer and stay in the country all the time, but we will go back to the city in September, when the schools open. We had a nice picnic and "fish-fry" on the Fourth at the Maramec River, near here; waded in the cool clear water, and gathered so many mussel shells; rowed in the boat, made pawpaw whistles, and had lots of fun.

EARLY D.

KANSAS.

ELK CITY,

This is the second time we have written to your paper together; the first letter was not published. We like the stories very much, especially "Mr. Stubbs's Brother"; we always read that first. It rained very hard last night, and this morning the banks of the rivers are nearly overflowed. We have one dog; his name is Carlo; he will be four months old next Sunday. He is so full of mischief. One day we went in the bedroom and found him playing with mamma's bonnet; he tore the ribbon, and came pretty near spoiling the feather. We will look in every number for this until it is published.

CORA W.

MARY and

I had a little dog once who used to play just such tricks, and oh! how angry he sometimes made people by his funny antics and his mischief! I am glad mamma's feather escaped Carlo's teeth. Well, never mind; if he lives long enough, he will become a sober and dignified dog.

Little Evelyn G., who also has a dog named Carlo, can shake hands with Mary and Cora W.

CONNECTICUT.

HARTFORD,

I do love you so much! How good it seems to see your dear little bright green face every week. I have an auntie in New Bedford, grown up and married, who sees you and reads you all through before you come to me. I go to New Brunswick and Martha's Vineyard every summer, and with my cousin Dolly have great fun bathing in the salt-water. Dollie is one week younger than myself. I am twelve years old; my name is Gertie. I learned to swim last summer. We always take our pets with us. Last summer I had two bantam chicks. I loved Toney best, and he grew to be a beautiful rooster, and then died. It is very hard to lose things we love. Mamma says things we prize are first to vanish. I hope my dear YOUNG PEOPLE will never leave me.

GERTIE S.

P. S.—I heard my auntie say you were "cute." I guess, from the way she said it, she meant splendid.

Thanks, dear, for your good opinion. I am very glad you have learned to swim. I wish all my young friends who live near the water would do the same.

ILLINOIS.

DECATUR,

I write to reproach you for cruelty to an unfortunate boy. Poor Toby Tyler ran away with the circus, and had on a very old hat. Months have passed, and still you have not given him a new hat. I think Abner might cut off some of the brim of his, and let Aunt Olive mend Toby's with it. But as Abner is sick, I suppose when he recovers he will need all of his own hat to keep the sun off. I send a nickel to get Toby a new hat. What if the boys do call them "Nickel Katies"? It will be better than the thing Toby wears now.

A

sympathizer with Toby,

FANNIE G.

Jolly Toby Tyler does not care for a new hat, and so I will send your money, dear, if you please, to help along the Young People's Cot Fund.

PENNSYLVANIA.

PHILADELPHIA,

Aunt Bessie subscribed for YOUNG PEOPLE; she always calls me Effie, but my name is Evelyn. I have a little dog; his name is Carlo. He is a comical little thing, and he wants to tear everything to pieces, and loves to play with me. I have a pet bird; her name is Cherry. The bottom of her cage came half off the other day while papa was in the yard and mamma in town, but she did not get away. I have a cat whose name is Neddie. He does not like Carlo. When Neddie spits at Carlo I scold him, but that does not do any good. Mamma wrote this for me, as I do not write plain enough.

EVELYN G.

C. Y. P. R. U.

SOME FAMILIAR WORDS, AND WHERE THEY COME FROM.

Every young reader has heard puss called Tabby, but all do not know that tabby cat was named after Atab, a famous street in the old city of Bagdad. On this street the merchants sold a beautiful watered silk called atabi. In modern days this silk has been styled taffeta. The wavy markings of the silk were thought to resemble pussy's coat of fur.

Jet derives its name from a river in Lycia—the Gagates—in the bed of which were found smooth black stones called gaet, of which jewelry was made.

A pamphlet is a book bound in paper. A long, long time ago a learned Greek lady wrote the history of the world in thirty-five little books, which, after her, were called Pamphylia.

Humbug is a bit of fun aimed at Hamburg, in Germany, which city was once rather famous for getting up sensations which turned out to be nothing very wonderful after all. Hamburg news was humbug.

Dollar is from the German thaler, named from Thal, in Bohemia, where were located the silver-works which made this coin.

Money traces its history to a remote period, when the coinage of the Romans was struck at the temple of the goddess Juno Monieta.

PANSY.—The Postmistress will find out what you wish to know if she can. Please send her your own full name and address.

TO PUZZLERS.—Clever little people who send puzzles will please remember that enigmas must rhyme, and that the answers must always be sent with the puzzles. Do not make enigmas upon your own Christian or surname, or the name of a friend, as it is almost impossible for our great circle of readers to guess such puzzles.

GAZETTA.—Wiggles, puzzles, answers to puzzles, exchanges, and all letters for Our Post-office Box should be sent to the Editor of HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE, Franklin Square, New York.

LILY F.—"Margie's Adventure" is a very pretty story indeed for a girl of your age to have written. It is rather too long for Our Post-office Box, but the Postmistress read it with pleasure, and thanks you for sending it.

We would call the attention of the C.Y.P.R.U. this week to "Historical Trees of Mexico," by Mrs. Helen S. Conant, and to "How a Boy was Hired Out, and What Came of It," by Mr. George Gary Eggleston. The boys will be interested in Mr. C. W. Fisher's directions "How to Make a Toy Canoe."

Correct answers to puzzles have been received from "Jan. U. Ary," Hartley Bishop, Elsie Grey, J. Hanse Gebley, Effie W. Rhind, Emma and Andrew Campbell, Harry Johnston, Charlie and Willie Lloyd, Edgar Seeman, Edward and Gustav Metz, Fannie Grimes, M. Portener, Alice Bartlett, John

Todd, Frank Groves, "Fuss and Feathers," Daisy Dean, Lewie Andrews, Augusta Schultz, Ethel Raymond, "Eureka," Rosa M. Benedict, "North Star," A. E. Thorp, "Jack and Jill," B. B. A., Mary M. Livingston, Robin Dykes, Hermann Miller, Lucy Campbell, Louise G., Fred Goodenough, Sydney Heinemann, "Old Putnam's Pet," Rosa Deffaa, Emma Roehm, and Frank Allan Ives.

PUZZLES FROM YOUNG CONTRIBUTORS.

No. 1.

FOUR DIAMONDS.

- 1.—1. A letter. 2. A human being. 3. Something for the table. 4. A light sleep. 5. A letter.
2.—1. A letter. 2. An animal. 3. A weapon. 4. Part of the head. 5. A letter.
3.—1. A letter. 2. Very angry. 3. A title given to a lady. 4. An obstruction. 5. A letter.
4.—1. A letter. 2. A fluid. 3. A sign of contempt. 4. View. 5. A letter.

ACCOUNT.

COUNT No

No. 2.

ANAGRAM.

Your page help person.

SEEMAN.

EDGAR

No. 3.

A HALF-SQUARE.—(*To Benny Fishel*).

1. The mulberry. 2. A nautical term. 3. A mark made by folding. 4. To accommodate. 5. The fruit of the oak or beech. 6. Resentment. 7. An abbreviation. 8. A letter.

I. SCYCLE.

No. 4.

INVERTED PYRAMID.

Across.—1. A white stone. 2. Narcotics. 3. Furnished with ears. 4. An animal. 5. A letter.

Down.—1. A letter. 2. An interjection. 3. An animal. 4. Inclination. 5. A man's name. 6. Confusion.
7. To spread abroad new-mown grass. 8. An abbreviation. 9. A letter.

I. SCYCLE.

No. 5.

ENIGMA.

From that half-dozen, miss, take nine,
And from that nine take half of twenty.
'Tis easy done so far; but now
You must from forty borrow fifty,
Then you will see it is quite plain
Just half a dozen still remain.

No. 6.

WORD SQUARE.

1. Part of the body. 2. To come in. 3. To reconcile. 4. Gaps. 5. A ringlet.

HELEN.

ANSWERS TO PUZZLES IN No. 142.

No. 1.

Michael Angelo.

No. 2.

L C
COT DOT

LOVER COVER
 TEA TEN
 R R
 C S T
 CUP NET LEG
 CUPID SEVENTEXAS
 PIE TEN GAP
 D N S

No. 3

1. G-old. C-oat. C-up. S-in. P-ink. H-and. F-red-red-ed.
2. C-ore. S-hovel. Y-ear. S-tick. S-hoe. S-pool. T-rick. D-rug.

No. 4.

A dreary place would be this earth,
 Were there no little people in it;
 The song of life would lose its mirth,
 Were there no children to begin it.

[For Exchanges, see 2d and 3d pages of cover.]

A NEW SERIAL.

"THE CRUISE OF THE CANOE CLUB,"

By W. L. ALDEN,

AUTHOR OF "THE MORAL PIRATES," "CRUISE OF THE 'GHOST,'" ETC.

In the next number of YOUNG PEOPLE our readers will have a chance to renew the acquaintance of the four lads whose adventures they followed so eagerly in Mr. Alden's former stories. This time the boys have become the fortunate possessors of four canoes, in which they make a cruise through some of the rivers and lakes of Canada. Just in proportion as a canoe excels a row-boat or a sail-boat in its easy motion, its delightful swiftness, and its liability to capsize, so do the experiences and adventures of the boys on this cruise exceed those of the cruises that have preceded it in excitement, picturesqueness, and general interest. Mr. Alden's stories for young readers are full of the genial wit and clever handling of amusing situations that have won him such a brilliant reputation as a humorist.



**WHAT FIVE INSECTS ARE
REPRESENTED IN THIS PICTURE?**

A HORSE WHICH MADE A SENSATION.

Tahiti is one of the Society Islands, a small group in the Southern Pacific, lying many hundreds of miles away from any mainland. The Spaniards claim to have discovered them first, but it was famous Captain Cook who explored them thoroughly, and carried the story of their wonderful tropical fruits and strange inhabitants back to England.

Some years after, the good people of England began to send missionaries to the islands. They were well received, and among their converts was King Pomare.

Now neither King Pomare nor any of his subjects had ever seen a horse, and as they were curious to know something about an animal which the English people described as so noble and willing and useful, it was finally decided that one should be sent him as a present. So among the cargo of a vessel sent to Tahiti from New South Wales was a splendid horse, with a silky coat and flowing mane and tail, for King Pomare.

It was originally intended that the horse should be taken ashore from the vessel in which he had made his voyage, in a large canoe which had been sent alongside for the purpose, but the slings in which he was fastened gave way as he was being lowered, and the poor animal fell into the sea. He at once struck boldly out for the land; but the natives no sooner saw him than they plunged into the waves and swam after him like a shoal of porpoises; they seized his tail and his mane, and nearly pulled him under. The King shouted and the Captain screamed at them in vain, while the terrified

horse struggled as hard as he could. As soon as he reached the land the crowd there fled for their lives in every direction, climbing rocks and trees, and hiding behind bushes. One by one, however, they returned when they saw a sailor slip a halter around the creature's neck and lead him along.

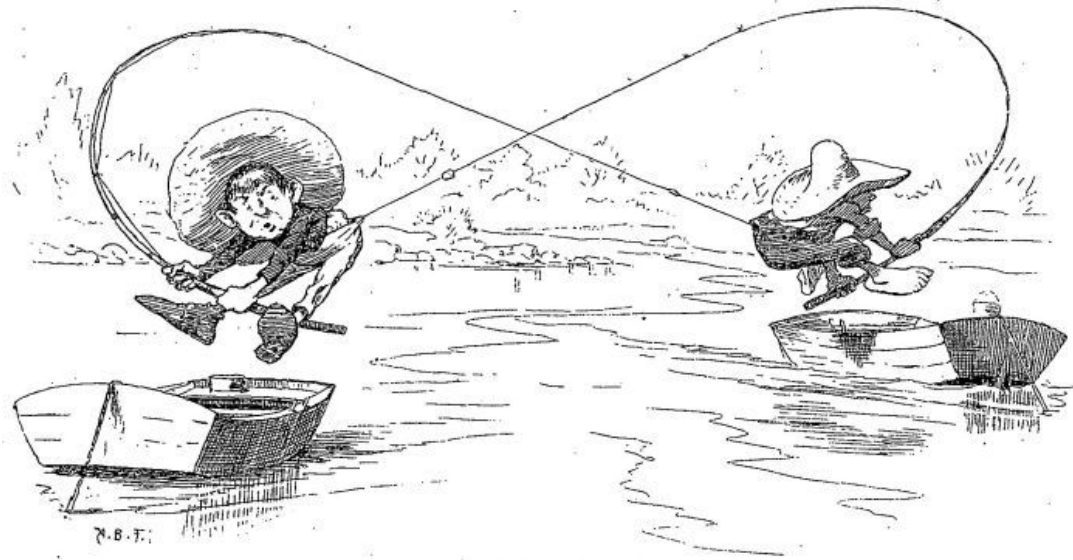
Next morning, in the presence of a great number of admiring natives, the Captain put a saddle on the horse, and rode him up and down before the King's tent. As he cantered, galloped, and trotted, obedient to the rein, the people shouted and danced, crying *Buaa-hora-fenna* and *Buaa-afai-taata* (land-running pig, and man-carrying pig).

PARLOR MAGIC.

THE MYSTERIOUS BOX.

The use of this box is as follows: Hand the box round for examination, and allow a marked dime to be put into it. Let one of the company lock the box and keep the key, and also tie a string round it lengthways and crossways, lay it on the table, touch it with your wand, and command the dime to vanish and pass into a tumbler, hat, etc. Tell the person who locked the box to open it and see if he can find the dime within, when, to the astonishment of all, it will be found to have vanished from the box, and be found in the place you indicated.

The secret of this box is as follows: The bottom is divided into three or four panels, one of the end ones of which is on a swivel exactly in the centre, and fixed in its place by a nail at each side, the box being put together with driving nails. The nails being all alike, there is no likelihood of the secret being discovered. The trick is performed as follows: When the box has been tied and locked, hold the box on a slope to the swivel end, slip out the two nails just far enough to allow the panel to move, push up one end, and the dime will fall out at the other into your hand. Shut the slide, and put the nails into their places again, lay the box down on the table, go for your magic wand, and take that opportunity of putting the dime into the hat or elsewhere.



A MOST SUCCESSFUL CAST.

FOOTNOTES:

[\[1\]](#) Begun in No. 127, HARPER'S YOUNG PEOPLE.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK HARPER'S
YOUNG PEOPLE, AUGUST 8, 1882 ***

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